

Read right through the Bible, not just selected portions.

F. Read it resolutely.

Obey that which the Father teaches from His book.

G. Read it daily.

Not just on Sundays but every day of your life.

Make your Bible your constant companion in life. The Word of God, if neglected, will be your judge at the last days. (John 12:48)

VI. Here are a few guidelines on how to study the Word:

A. Set a regular time for study. The amount of time a Christian should spend in his study depends on several factors: availability of materials, references, resources that will aid him in his study, and the speed with which he can study a single message, etc. The ideal amount of time for study, therefore, varies from pastor to pastor.

B. Pray before studying the Bible. Seek the guidance of the Holy Spirit in your study of the Word.

PRAYER

Prayer is the daily experience of God. It is the key to maintaining and to maturing the love relationship, revealing the meaning of Scripture, extending God's invitations, and directing your life into major adjustments and obedience. Prayer is the offering of all our desires to God with a humble confidence that we shall obtain mercy through Jesus Christ our Lord.

- It is the soul's desire to God. (Psalm 42:1-2; 63:1-3; 84:2; 143:6-9)
- It is a cry, a supplication (Exodus 22:23; Psalm 34:17; 86:3; 88:1-2,13; Isaiah 19:20)
- It is an instinct that must have an utterance. (Isaiah 44:17; 45:20; Luke 18:7,13)
- It is an appeal from the child to the Father. (Hosea 14:3; Matthew 6:6; Luke 11-12)
- It is described as:
 - *a beseeching to the Lord.* (Exodus 32:11)
 - *a calling on the Lord* (Acts 7:59; Romans 10:12-14)
 - *a lifting up of the heart to the Lord* (Lam. 3:41; Psalm 25:1)
 - *a pouring out of the heart to the Lord* (Psalm 62:8; I Sam. 1:15)
 - *a seeking of the face of the Lord* (Psalm 27:8)

I. HOW TO PRAY

- A. **Pray to the *Father*** (Luke 11:2) **in the name of *Jesus Christ*** (John 14: 13-14) **through the power of the *Holy Spirit*** (Ephesians 6:18).
- B. **Pray continually** (Romans 12:12; 1Thessalonians 5:17).
 - ...*in faith* (Mark 11:24; Hebrews 10:22)
 - ...*with a forgiving spirit* (Mark 11:25)
 - ...*with perseverance* (Luke 11:8; 18:1-7)
 - ...*in righteousness* (Psalm 34:15; John 15:7)

Suggested Procedures on How to Pray:

1. **Set a regular time for quality prayer.** A cluttered mind results in personal chaos. A cluttered spirit needs prayer to clear it up and give it direction. Make prayer the first order of the day.
2. **Look for that 'secret place'.** Locate that specific place in your house where the manifested communing presence of God is real, actual to you.
3. **Don't set a specific time limit.** You will defeat yourself from the start. Prayer will become a task – a heavy burden – rather than a door into a loving relationship with your heavenly Father.
4. **Begin with thanksgiving and praise.** Giving thanks and praise is your soul's offering to God. The Holy Spirit meets your spirit as you give yourself to worship.

5. **Repent.** Remember that your purpose is to have your heart cleansed. Hiding nothing from God will only be meaningful if it leads you to completely and resolutely turning your back on sin.
6. **Let your heart commune with God's heart.** The operative words are: surrender, give up. You are a child before your Father. Let Him listen to the occupations of your heart and then let your heart listen to Him.
7. **Petition God's help.** God's Word so grips us that we are prompted to respond by praying for so many concerns. These concerns flow in the following areas:
 - a. **World.** There is power in prayer. The governments of the world suffer from greed that results in hunger, corruption of power and war. We can touch this suffering world through prayer.
 - b. **Nation.** We can never pray too much for our leaders. They, of all people, need that touch of God. Praying for them is equal to praying for our national concerns.
 - c. **Israel.** What happens to this chosen nation of God determines what will happen to the world in general. Israel is so special to God that, whenever we pray for her, our hearts beat in unison with God's.
 - d. **Body of Christ.** *"Though we are many, we are one body..."* (1Corinthians 12:12). It is our obligation to pray for one another, to strengthen, encourage and fortify one another in God. The Body of Christ is God's hand working towards the fulfillment of His grand plan as stated in His Word.
 - e. **The JIL Church.** We must have keen knowledge of the congregation's needs. These needs are what we bring to God in prayer.
 - f. **Community.** Our Christianity is manifested in the persons that we are in our localities. We are the spiritual community heads – and we owe it to the people of our community to have the first burden for its welfare.
 - g. **Other needs.** We are the Levites of today who will intercede on behalf of others for:
 - *healings.*
 - *those in prison.*
 - *the oppressed.*
 - *deliverance from binding spirits.*
 - *blessings in finances.*
 - h. **Family.** Your family is your Jerusalem. Do not neglect them.
 - i. **Self.** The uncharged leader has no capacity to lead.
8. **Receive God's revelation.** Listen. God cannot uncover His plan if you do all the talking.

9. **End in a statement of faith. Claim God's promise of help.** *"So I say to you: Ask and it will be given to you; seek and you will find; knock and the door will be opened to you. For everyone who asks receives; he who seeks finds; and to him who knocks, the door will be opened."* (Luke 11:9,10)

C. Pattern for Prayer

- A** doration: praise and worship of the soul of the Lord (Psalm 95:6)
- C** onfession: repentance from every sin (Psalm 32:5)
- T** hanksgiving (Philippians 4:6)
- S** upplication: intercession, request, petition and desires (1Timothy 2:1)

II. WHERE TO PRAY

The believer...

- A. may pray everywhere (1Timothy 2:8)
- B. must pray in the closet (Matthew 6:6)
- C. must pray in the temple/church (Luke 18:10; Psalm 26:12)

III. WHEN TO PRAY

Pray...

- A. in the morning (Psalm 55:17; 5:3)
- B. at noon and at evening (Ps. 55:17)
- C. day and night (Ps. 88:1)
- D. always (Luke 18:1; 1Thessalonians 5:17)
- E. daily (Ps. 86:3)

IV. POSTURES IN PRAYER

Pray...

- A. with bowed head (Genesis 24:26, 48)
- B. while falling on the face (Numbers 16:22)
- C. while kneeling (1Kings 8:54; Ezra 9:5)
- D. while standing (Luke 18:13)
- E. while sitting
- F. with the lifting up of hands (Nehemiah 8:6)
- G. while looking up
- H. with the spreading out of hands (Exodus 9:29)
- I. with weeping (1Samuel 1:10)
- J. with talking (Genesis 18:23-33)
- K. with agonizing (Luke 22:44)
- L. with groaning (Romans 8:26-27)

V. HINDRANCES TO PRAYER

- A. Unbelief (James 1:6-7)
- B. Iniquity, sin (Psalm 66:18; Isaiah 59:1-2)
- C. An unforgiving spirit (Mark 11:25)
- D. Wrong motives (James 4:3)
- E. Neglect of mercy (Proverbs 21:13)

Prayer is the backbone of the Church. It is the power source of every Christian. It energizes; it transforms.

Our Lord Jesus Christ always sought retirement for prayer. He who is imbued with all the power of God, the Alpha and the Omega, the King of Kings—no less felt and modeled the necessity of a life of prayer.